

▽ The *Spirit of St Louis*,
Charles Lindbergh's aircraft



1927

LINDBERGH MAKES SOLO ATLANTIC FLIGHT

In May, American aviator Charles Lindbergh flew from New York to Paris, becoming the first person to complete a solo non-stop transatlantic flight. His aircraft *Spirit of St Louis* was buffeted by high winds and rain. Lindbergh made the 5,793-km (3,600-mile) journey in 33 hours 30 minutes. More than 100,000 people were waiting to see him land.

1928 American **Amelia Earhart** becomes the first woman to fly across the Atlantic

1928 Scottish physician Alexander Fleming discovers penicillin

1928 The Kuomintang (Chinese Nationalist Party) led by Chiang Kai-shek take Beijing and set up a national government

1929

▽ Promotional poster for *The Jazz Singer*



1927

THE "TALKIES" ARRIVE

Cinema changed forever when audiences could hear recorded sound along with the images. First seen was a film of Charles Lindbergh taking off on his celebrated flight (above), but it was the first talking feature film, *The Jazz Singer* starring Al Jolson, that achieved great popularity.

1928 In the Soviet Union, Joseph Stalin orders collectivization of agriculture in a programme of radical economic change

▽ A stockbroker sells his car



1929

THE WALL STREET CRASH

Following a period of speculation after World War I, share prices faltered. On 24 October – which came to be known as “Black Thursday” – the market plunged; this was followed by a price crash on 29 October, as some 16 million shares were traded. Thousands of investors were ruined as the crash marked the beginning of a worldwide economic depression.